

IB MYP Year 7 I&S — Group Investigation – Anay Rustogi

Unit 3: What do people believe in? Individuals & Societies Year 7 2025-26

Global Religions Investigation

Goal- To understand that **belief systems** can help shape how **identities** are **formed**, expressed, and transformed within a society.

Role- An investigative reporter for a TV news channel.

Audience: The viewers of the TV channel.

Situation- The producer of your TV channel has asked you to investigate and create a **presentation** to highlight a belief system in the world.

Purpose: To provide information on a belief system in the world for your audience.

Standards- You will be assessed on

Criterion B- Investigating (i, ii, iii, and iv)

Criterion C- Communication (i, ii, iii)

Criterion D- Critical Thinking (i and iv)

Assessment criteria

	Criteria B: Investigating
0	The student does not reach a standard described by any of the descriptors given below.
1-2	i. identifies your choice of a global belief system ii. follows an action plan in a limited way to explore a research question iii. collects and records information, to a limited extent iv. with guidance, reflects on the research process and results, to a limited extent.
3-4	i. describes your choice of a global belief system ii. partially follows an action plan to explore a research question iii. uses a method or methods to collect and record some relevant information iv. with guidance, reflects on the research process and results with some depth .
5-6	i. describes your choice of a global belief system question in detail ii. mostly follows an action plan to explore a research question iii. uses method(s) to collect often relevant information iv. reflects on the research process and results .
7-8	i. explains your choice of a global belief system ii. effectively follows an action plan to explore a research question iii. uses methods to collect and record consistently relevant information iv. thoroughly reflects on the research process and results .

	Criteria C: Communicating
0	The student does not reach a standard described by any of the descriptors given below.
1-2	i. communicates information and ideas in a style that is not always clear

	ii. organizes information and ideas in a limited way iii. inconsistently lists sources, not following the task instructions.
3-4	i. communicates information and ideas in a way that is somewhat clear ii. somewhat organizes information and ideas iii. lists sources in a way that sometimes follows the task instructions.
5-6	i. communicates information and ideas in a way that is mostly clear ii. mostly organizes information and ideas iii. lists sources in a way that often follows the task instructions.
7-8	i. communicates information and ideas in a way that is completely clear ii. completely organizes information and ideas effectively iii. lists sources in a way that always follows the task instructions.

	Criteria D: Critical Thinking
0	The student does not reach a standard described by any of the descriptors given below.
1-2	i. identifies the main points of ideas of the chosen global belief system. iv. identifies some different views.
3-4	i. identifies some main points of ideas of the chosen global belief system. iv. identifies some different views and suggests some of their implications.
5-6	i. Identifies the main points of ideas of the chosen global belief system. iv. identifies different views and most of their implications .
7-8	i. Identifies in detail the main points of ideas of the chosen global belief system. iv. consistently identifies different views and their implications

ATL skills

Social > Self-Management > Organisation Skills

- **Managing time and tasks effectively**
- Plan short- and long-term assignments; meet deadlines

Communication skills

- Exchanging thoughts, messages, and information effectively through interaction
- Use a variety of media to communicate with a range of audiences
- Reading, writing, and using language to gather and communicate information
- Write for different purposes

Respectful inquiry & academic honesty

- Use respectful language; avoid stereotypes or proselytizing. Discuss ideas and practices, not people.
- If using primary data (interview/survey), obtain consent; do not collect sensitive personal data.
- Paraphrase, quote sparingly, and cite all sources in your reference list.

Task Overview

Your goal is to work together in groups of 4–5, performing your assigned roles to investigate a world religion or worldview and deliver a short presentation to teach the audience. Your investigation and presentation must show how the belief system works as a **system** and **explain** how it can shape a person's identity. Your presentation should include a method of interaction to engage the audience.

Step 1: Choose a belief system to investigate as a group you might enjoy researching. Ideally it should be one that you do not practice as **our goal is to learn and to inform**. (Criterion B i)

- | | | |
|-----------------|--------------------------|----------------------|
| 1. Buddhism | 10. Sikhism | Aborigines, Maori, |
| 2. Atheist | 11. Jainism | Nubians, Uyghur, |
| 3. Agnostic | 12. Daoism | Achí, Ainu, Inuit or |
| 4. Humanist | 13. Indigenous beliefs | another North |
| 5. Judaism | (many to choose | American tribal |
| 6. Islam | from and here are | group) |
| 7. Hinduism | a few: Tuareg, | |
| 8. Christianity | Tlingit, Awa, | |
| 9. Shinto | | |

Step 2: Identify your RQ. **Explain** your choice of Research question (Criterion B i)

Research question: How does the Shinto religion function, and what are its beliefs?

Step 3: Create a group Action Plan. It can be a mind map or a chart. **Your choice**. (Criterion B ii)

Step 4: Conduct the research. **Keep** track of sources and information. **List** the questions you are researching. **Write** the answers you found. **List** the weblink (URL) or title of the source. Use at least **5 sources** and a variety. (Criterion B iii and Criterion D i and iv)

Questions:

- 1) What do Shinto followers believe in
- 2) What is the most important Kami
- 3) How do the Shinto followers offer to Kami
- 4) Who is the most important Kami
- 5) Can people become Kami after death?
- 6) How old is Shinto believed to be
- 7) Which area in Japan is the Shinto belief most popular and followed?
- 8) Why do people follow Shinto?
- 9) What do the Kami do for the village in exchange of offerings?

Step 5: Create your presentation. Be creative! No PowerPoints or Canva. Include an engaging activity as part of your presentation to captivate the audience. Yes, you will be presenting to the class. (Criterion i and ii)

Step 6: Create your MLA 9 Citations. (Criterion C iii)

Step 7: Reflection on the investigation process. (Criterion B iv)

Step 8: Upload your presentation (possibly only one member of the group- ask your teacher) to MB and Teams. Upload the worksheet as a PDF to MB **individually**.

Complete all parts below!

Step 2: Criterion B Strand i- Explain your choice of a global belief system
Group Research Question: How does Shinto shape identity formation for its followers?
Statement of Inquiry: Belief systems can help shape how identities are formed , expressed, and transformed within a society.

Explain why YOU selected this religion/belief system. Make the link to the Statement of Inquiry. Use bold words in your explanation: We selected this religion because it is extremely ancient, believed to be one of the oldest religions in Japan, moreover, it relates to nature, elements and their divine essence, also known as Kami.

Sub-questions: 4 group members= 4 questions per person.

Criterion D strands i and iv. Identify the main points of ideas (the chosen global belief system) and **iv. identify** different views and their implications.

1. What is the religion/belief system?
- 2.
2. Where does it come from (origins)? **Where and When**
3. Where is it practiced now? Consider a map to show this.
4. How many followers does it have now?
5. What kind of *theism* is it?
6. What are the core beliefs and values?
7. How is it practiced (**how do they practice what they believe- rituals and practices**)?
8. What are the leaders, if they have one, called?
9. Who are some significant individuals in that belief system? (this is where you use specific names)
10. What challenges does this belief system face?
11. Do they have any important literature?
12. How has their belief system changed over time or any variations in the belief system?
13. Case insight: What is one concrete example of how identity is expressed (names, dress, diet, moral choices, community life)?
14. How does it function as a system (parts, relationships, feedback/continuity & change)?
15. What are at least 2 perspectives or internal diversity (e.g., differing practices or interpretations) of this belief system?
16. What do different perspectives imply for the belief system?

Step 3: Criterion B strand ii: Create and follow an action plan to explore your choice of a global belief system. Your plan should include:

1. The steps outlined in the task overview
2. The sub-questions
3. Group roles:

- a. **Facilitator** - To clarify the team's objectives, ensure every member understands their role and may assign tasks to members so that the team can achieve its goals. Keep members on task.
 - b. **Arbitrator**- Observe group interactions, intercede to prevent conflict, ensuring all sides can be heard.
 - c. **Coach**-To know the task and roles and support team members to overcome obstacles.
 - d. **Evaluator**- Measures the team's progress in working toward the group objective and communicates with members to validate the completion of their tasks and make sure everyone agrees on roles and expectations.
 - e. **Compromiser**- Recognizes when conflict occurs between team members and formulates strategies for reaching a compromise. They help the team overcome challenges by explaining both sides and collecting feedback about how to find a reasonable solution that works well for everyone. While the **arbitrator** may work to **prevent** issues from occurring, **compromisers thrive at resolving active conflicts**.
4. Dates for each step are due.
 5. The person responsible for each step and sub-question.
See the sample for guidance.

Insert plan here (mind map, chart, your choice)- consider using the action plan from the 1st assessment to help your group create a detailed plan. **Mind Map Example**

https://www.canva.com/design/DAG9v0KMlVI/TAYaY_LmYf2s9o7j2BoXjQ/view?utm_content=DAG9v0KMlVI&utm_campaign=designshare&utm_medium=link2&utm_source=uniquelinks&utlId=h4e1d9f1438

Example:

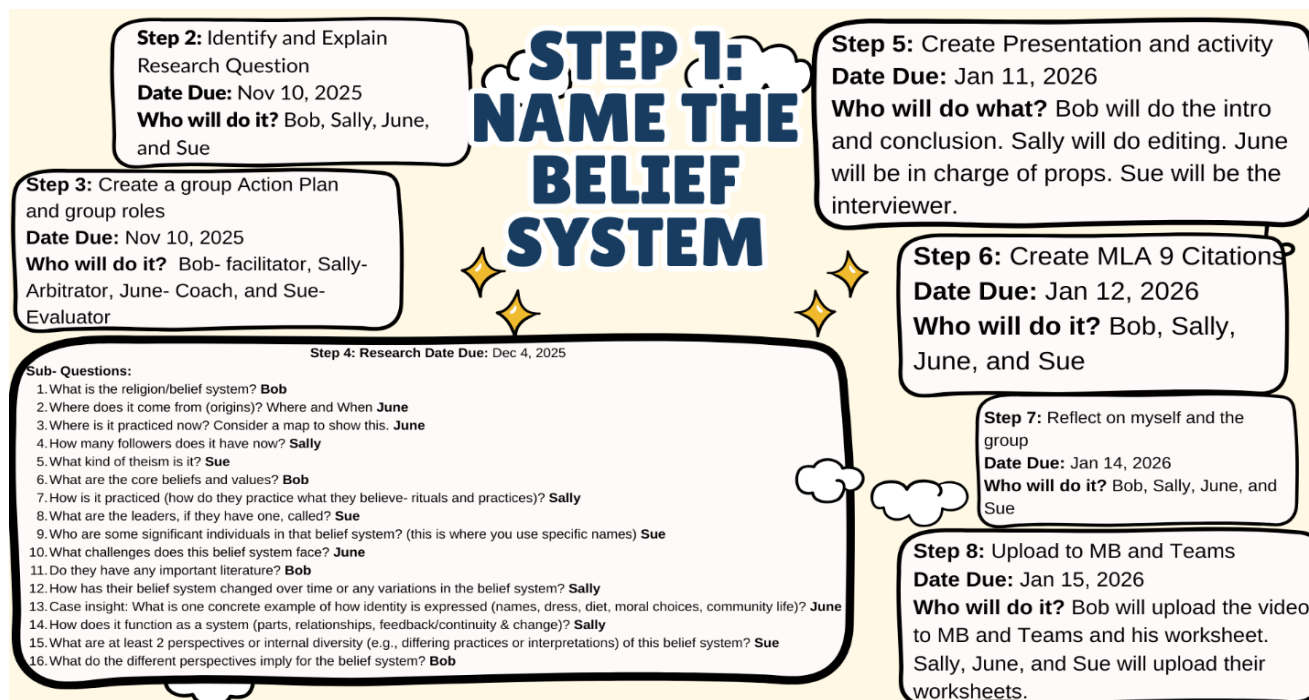


Chart Example:

Criterion B strand ii. create and follow an action plan to explore your choice of a global belief system.		
This is to be done FIRST. Do not move on to ANYTHING until this has been completed.		
Feel free to add steps as you see necessary for detail and individual group research direction.		
Action Steps	Responsibilities	Timeline
What needs to be done?	Who?	By When?
Step 1: Choose a belief system	Anay Rustogi, Samara Mimani and Adam Kamel	Nov 09, 2025
Step 2: Identify and explain a research question.	Anay Rustogi	Nov 10, 2025,
Step 3: Create an action plan	Anay Rustogi, Adam Kamel	Nov 12, 2025
Step 4: Research 1. What is the religion/belief system? 2. Where does it come from (origins)? Where and When 3. Where is it practiced now? Consider a map to show this. 4. How many followers does it have now?	1. Anay & Samara 2. Anay & Samara	All Group member's research will

5. What kind of <i>theism</i> is it? 6. What are the core beliefs and values? 7. How is it practiced (how do they practice what they believe- rituals and practices)? 8. What are the leaders, if they have one, called? 9. Who are some significant individuals in that belief system? (this is where you use specific names) 10. What challenges does this belief system face? 11. Do they have any important literature? 12. How has their belief system changed over time or any variations in the belief system? 13. Case insight: What is one concrete example of how identity is expressed (names, dress, diet, moral choices, community life)? 14. How does it function as a system (parts, relationships, feedback/continuity & change)? 15. What are at least 2 perspectives or internal diversity (e.g., differing practices or interpretations) of this belief system? 16. What do different perspectives imply for the belief system?	3. Anay 4. Anay 5. Samara 6. Anay 7. Anay 8. Samara 9. Anay 10. Adam 11. Samara & Adam 12. Samara & Adam 13. Anay 14. Adam 15. Samara 16. Anay	be due Dec 4, 2025
Step 5: Create the website and Kahoot! 1. Researcher 2. Designer 3. Websiter creator 4. Quiz creator 5. Blooket creator 6. Paperwork creator	1. Anay, Samara, Adam 2. Anay 3. Anay 4. Anay 5. Adam 6. Samara	Jan 6, 2026
Step 6: MLA 9 citations	Samara will complete	Jan 7, 2026
Step 7: Reflect on the process, finish reflecting	Anay, Adam & Samara will complete individually	Jan 8, 2026
Step 8: Upload and this worksheet as a PDF to Managebac by the due date- each member of the group must upload. Upload the presentation to MB and Teams by the due date- one member only must do this.	Anay will upload project to MB and Teams. Anay, Adam and Samara will upload	Jan 8, 2026

	individual worksheets to MB.	
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Step 4: Research your belief system, keeping track of your information. **(Criterion B strand iii: collect and record relevant information consistent with your chosen religion)**

Minimum of 5 sources **per person in the group**. This is individual- **only sources YOU used**.

Questions I had? Use your sub-questions here.	Answers I found:	Weblink or book/article title of the source I used.
What do Shinto Believe in?	“One of the core beliefs of the Shinto religion is the idea that everything possesses a spiritual essence or energy called “kami.” Mountains, rivers, places, animals and people are said to have kami inside.”	https://www.econdolence.com/learning-center/religion-and-culture/shinto/understanding-shinto?srsId=AfmBOordopul-L4yJio3eiKgCH7qpnXsDwzmSYOfcoFYD94212zzxNLq
Who are the demons in Shinto?	“Occasionally, when a human is so utterly wicked that his soul is beyond	https://yokai.com/oni/?srsId=AfmBOooY_sk33ZLZ3pQZmOWa4XMTwTB_At07hlzGxYc4o31P5V

	any redemption, he transforms into an oni while still alive. He then remains on earth to terrorize the living. These transformed oni are the ones most legends tell about, and the ones who pose the most danger to humankind.”	
How do Shinto respect their gods	“Additionally, it is also possible to do your own offering at home. All you need is a home shrine, and some food and drinks to offer! In this case, the easiest option is to offer salt or rice. But you have other options!”	https://www.japanlivingguide.com/expatinfo/religions/shinto-offerings/

Who is the most important god	“Among this vast pantheon, one kami stands above the rest: Amaterasu-Ōmikami, the sun goddess.”	https://int.japanesetaste.com/blogs/japanese-taste-blog/10-shinto-gods-to-know-when-visiting-japan-s-shrines?srsltid=AfmBOorw1dYXkyMR54AF73EaCUzY-NWOjVivYMkZCUP7wrU4Yol&shpxid=f52dcc04-54c6-4025-a8fd-102e8821b1f7
What festivals does the main country celebrate for Shinto	“Gion Matsuri (祇園祭), the festival of Yasaka Shrine, is the most famous Shinto festival in Japan. It takes place over the entire month of July.” “Kanda Matsuri Taking place in May, floats filled with dancers and portable shrines are paraded throughout Tokyo to honor deities or kami at the Kanda shrine. It commemorates the victory at the Battle of Sekigahara. It’s celebrated in	https://www.japan-guide.com/e/e3942.html https://www.diversityresources.com/shintoism-beliefs-and-holidays/

	odd-numbered years.” “Gion Matsuri Throughout the entire month of July, Kyoto celebrates Gion Matsuri with large floats accompanied by musicians. It started as a purification ritual during a plague outbreak, which people believed was caused by spirits.”	
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Step 5: Create the presentation using your research. **Do not forget** an activity to engage the audience. (**Criterion C strands i communicate** information and ideas in a style that is clear **and ii organize** information and ideas effectively for the presentation):

codemaster-ar.github.io/Shinto

Suggestions/ideas:

- Exit quiz
- Kahoot! or the like that YOU make
- Perspective cards
- Two truths and a myth
- Concept sort
- Learning Stations

Step 6: Create your MLA 9 Citations. **Place the citations at the end of this document.** (**Criterion C strand iii- list** sources of information in a way that follows the task instructions):

<https://www.mybib.com/b/RD689o>

Step 7: Criterion B strand iv. Reflect on the process and results of the investigation. This is individual for yourself and then reflect on the group.		
Research areas	My reflection of my work	
In general, what went well?		
Collection of sources and recording information?	1. What ATLs did you use the most during the research?	1. Anay Rustogi: I used research (searching up for information and details), thinking (figuring out how to execute our project, website and layout and communication (Communicating with my team to do work)
	2. Why are the ATLs important?	2. These ATLS are indispensable as their research is what helped us gather information legally using citations, thinking, creation of our project, how to make it interactive and fun after learning with quizzes and games, and finally, communication. We had to communicate online and face-to-face to set deadlines and have a clear idea of our goal/target.
	3. Explain how you used a variety of sources.	3. We used multiple sources to verify our data; since most sources are created by humans, they might have slight inaccuracies or mistakes. Therefore, we match sources with each other to find mistakes and not use redundant data on our website/project.
	4. Why were these sources useful?	4. The sources that we used were an asset, as they were are best source of information, ususally reliable, and also something which you can verify. We got lots of verified statistics and information because of these sources.
	5. If you did not use a range of sources, why not?	5. We primarily used secondary sources (articles) as they were the easiest to verify and understand. There was no point in using other forms of sources, as we could already verify the data

		through other secondary sources and quickly scan through for important details without wasting time on unimportant ones.
	6. Was keeping track of the information easy?	6. Keeping track of the information was pretty easy, as we kept on adding bits and pieces down on our website, and saved the links of the sources on our document. Finally, we fine-tuned the data and rephrased it on our page/quiz/paper.
	7. What part did you find difficult?	7. I found gathering information the most difficult as not every site had the information we were actually looking for, so we kept on refining search terms and queries until we found the correct data. Moreover, we also had to scan the entire page to see if it had the correct data. Finally, we had to match the statistics to other websites to see if they are accurate, and give citations to all websites that were used, even for verifying data.
	8. How was the information you collected relevant to your questions?	8. The information we gathered was relevant to our inquiry question and overall topic as most of it delved into the rituals of Shinto followers and the supernatural, divine spirits such as Kami, which is an integral part of their culture. Other pieces of data talked about Shinto's history (300 BCE) and where it is followed most (Japan), it is also the 6th most followed religion on this planet.
Structuring & designing the project	1. What was your plan for the project?	1. Our plan was to start researching after finalizing our inquiry question and topic, then begin creating our project and piecing everything together to make a fun and interesting website that can teach people about Shinto, and quiz them as well.
	2. Was the plan useful?	2. The plan came in handy when checking for due dates, setting

		milestones and completing tasks (e.g: When to finish research). This helped us to finish our whole project before the deadline passed.
	3. Explain the ATL skills you used for the plan.	3. When making the plan, we used communication, to split the roles equally
Referencing of sources (work cited)	1. How did you keep track of all your sources of information?	1. We kept on noting key information down as we moved down, with the site as well if we needed more information from that web page.
	2. Did you use MLA9 format to cite? Encounter any issues?	2. No major issues were encountered, but some sites did not publish the name of the author, or the date released, therefore some of the citations our partially incomplete.
	3. Did you use a website to help you cite your sources?	3. Yes, we used www.mybib.com for helping us with out MLA9 formates and hosting our citation document.
What could you improve on to make the task even better?		
Overall Assessment	1. Are you happy with the overall outcome?	1. I am proud of my team and the overall outcome; we have created a powerful site that can teach people about Shinto in a fun way – even though it involved reading. It is well formatted, interactive and has enough to teach someone about Shinto’s important history and their blessed Kami.
	2. What could you do to improve your research skills?	2. Do improve my research skills, I could use a different range of sources instead of just secondary sources like blogs or websites, this will help me to aquire newer information and further reduces the chance of any inaccuracies.
Your individual evaluation of the Group		
How well was the group able to stay on task during the		Examples:

project? How did you manage your time? Give examples.		Very well, we kept on working on the physical output, and the digital project as well, to ensure that it can easily be presented and is interactive/fun for audience
How did the group organize the work logically? Give examples.		Examples: We organized the work by talents, for an example, Samara is great at writing/creating physical projects, while Anay is best at designing, and Adam is at the top for creating fun quizzes and helping the team on both, digital and physical sides. Everyone was outstanding at research though.
How was the group able to find examples to illustrate the main points? Give examples.		Examples: We brainstormed ideas for a possible religions and projects and conducted research about religions to see which one fit us best.
What were the strengths and weaknesses as a group? Give examples.		Examples: Anay is the best at coding, designing websites and interactive quizzes with Adam to provide audience with information in an extremely fun way, while Saicrosoft Teamsara iMBderful at creating physical, easy to read, eye-catching information cards that would give detail at first glance.
What targets would you set yourself when you do group work next?	I would make sure to communicate earlier and gather contact details much earlier before submission is due to ensure easy communication and co-ordination.	

Step 8: Upload your presentation (possibly only one member of the group) to MB and Teams. Upload the worksheet as a PDF to MB individually.

Task checklist sheet- At the end double check to make sure you did it all!

- ☐ **Step 1: Chose a religion/belief system to research.**
- ☐ **Step 2: Explained (justify) why you chose that belief system.**
- ☐ **Step 3: Planned your investigation. (Action Plan)**
- ☐ **Step 4: Researched and listed at least 5 sources.**
- ☐ **Step 5: Created a presentation to show your information.**
- ☐ **Step 6: MLA 9 Citations.**
- ☐ **Step 7: Reflected using the prompts.**

- **Step 8: Upload the presentation and worksheet to MB. Upload the presentation to Teams. (option as per the teacher).**

Criterion C- Strand iii: list sources of information in a way that follows the task instructions (MLA 9 Citations). **Only the sources YOU used.**

Works Cited